Donald Smith

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SUMMARY

Automation engineer with 20 years in games who turns a rough problem into a working tool fast. Built internal C# tools that replaced manual build and submission steps with API-driven automation, and ships personal software end-to-end, from a Firebase-backed orders app to a JavaScript front end. Uses Claude and Claude Code daily as a build partner for prototyping and AI-assisted workflows, and is completing Anthropic's Claude certification program. Comfortable starting from a conversation instead of a ticket, working independently, and flagging blockers early.

SKILLS

AI & Automation: Claude Code, Claude AI, LLM-assisted development, prompt engineering, API integration, workflow automation, rapid prototyping
Languages & Web: JavaScript, HTML/CSS, C#, Python, SQL
Data & Tools: Firebase, relational databases (SQL), MQTT, REST/platform APIs, Git/GitHub, Perforce, Jira, Visual Studio
Delivery: Test Automation, CI/CD, Release Management, Risk Assessment, Agile, Cross-functional Communication

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Owner | Ancient Design Works — Orange, CA *June 2020 – Present*
- Run a custom 3D printing and sculpting studio solo, from design and printing through finishing and delivery, for small businesses, artists, and collectors.
- Built the studio's own software, a Firebase-backed orders app and a browser-based instant price estimator, to support quoting and order handling without a dedicated team.
- Formed an LLC in December 2025 after landing a 100-unit production order, converting four years of word-of-mouth growth into a registered business.

QA Analyst | Nexon — El Segundo, CA *Sept 2025 – Present*
- Run commodity and storefront verification reports, reconciling deployed shop data against expected values to catch errors before they reach players.
- Triage player-reported issues and live feedback in real time, coordinating rapid validation and escalation with development teams to minimize live impact.
- Validate live-service builds against structured checklists to protect content parity and stability, keeping releases on schedule.

Jr. Software Development Engineer | TurtleRock Studios — Lake Forest, CA *Jan 2022 – Aug 2024*
- Built Turtle Tester, the studio's build and deployment hub, and other C# tools integrating Jenkins, Perforce, console platform APIs and Jira, automating build retrieval, console deploys, bug reporting and submissions that took hours by hand.
- Developed and maintained automated test suites (Blueprints + custom frameworks) to enforce quality gates across development and release cycles.
- Diagnosed and resolved integration and build-pipeline failures, cutting time-to-identify on release-blocking risks.

Sr. QA Analyst | TurtleRock Studios — Lake Forest, CA *Jan 2018 – Dec 2021*
- Owned end-to-end build submission for VR titles, verifying assets, metadata, and configurations were platform-ready before every release, and partnered daily with engineering and production to escalate blockers and verify fixes.

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Ancient Design Works — Business Website | HTML / CSS / JavaScript *In Progress*
- Designing and building a multi-page site for the studio solo, owning front-end architecture and design-system decisions from concept through deployment.
- Built a client-side Custom Order intake page that parses uploaded STL/OBJ files in the browser, computes model volume, and returns an instant price-range estimate with tunable cost inputs, prototyped quickly with Claude.

Ancient Design Works — Orders App | Firebase *Private Repo*
- Built an order-management application for the studio's client commissions with Firebase as the backend data store; walkthrough available on request.

Bambu Bridge — Android Print Monitor Widget | IoT / Mobile *In Progress*
- Self-directed build: a pinnable Android home-screen widget tracking multiple Bambu Lab 3D printers over local MQTT via a Raspberry Pi relay and Firebase Cloud Messaging push, so status is visible without opening an app. github.com/ACReturns/Bambu-Bridge

Command-Center — Build Launcher | C# / WPF *In Progress*
- Desktop tool to pull, patch and launch game builds on dev or live servers. github.com/ACReturns/Command-Center

XLSX Translator — Claude Skill | AI / Automation *Public*
- Translates Excel workbooks into any language, formulas intact. github.com/ACReturns/XLSX-Translator-Skill

CERTIFICATIONS & EDUCATION

Anthropic Claude Certification Program — *In Progress*

Certification in Software Development | The Tech Academy *Sept 2023 – June 2024*
- 600+ hour full-stack boot camp: JavaScript, HTML/CSS, SQL, C#, Python, C++, Django, .NET, MVC, and Agile/SCRUM, with hands-on web application projects.